

# Software Modernization Strategies



**Ignore It!**

Leave your system alone as long as it does its job well.



**Keep It Alive!**

Keep your legacy system running, but make it a conscious choice, not a habit.



**Delegate!**

Hand off what is holding you back and focus on what actually matters.



**Give It Away!**

Open-source what you can no longer advance alone, and let the community share the load.



**Sell It!**

Sell your legacy system to someone for whom it is worth more than it is to you.



**Buy New!**

Buy a ready-made solution when someone else has already solved your problem.



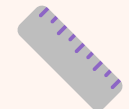
**Shut It Down!**

End your legacy system's operation in a planned, orderly, and drama-free way.



**Consolidate It!**

Replace your zoo of systems with fewer, more manageable units.



**Standardize It!**

Define how your systems are built, connected, and operated, and end the chaos.



**Harmonize It!**

Align your systems, models, and processes so they work together without friction.



**Partner It!**

Work with external partners to evolve your system together.



**Bring It Back!**

Take back control of your system when outsourcing costs more than it delivers.



**Rethink It!**

Do not question your system, question the assumptions it was built on.



**Remodel It!**

Align your system's structure with the domain as you understand it today.



**Trim it down!**

Remove what nobody needs anymore and give your system its actual purpose back.



**Improve It!**

Keep your system fit through continuous, unspectacular work before the debt catches up with you.



**Convert it!**

Keep your system's proven logic and only swap out the technology it lives in.



**Fork It!**

Split off part of your system and turn it into a standalone, independent solution.



**Repurpose It!**

Deploy your system for a new audience instead of maintaining it for a shrinking market.



**Salvage It!**

Keep the valuable components of your legacy system and leave the rest behind.



**Wrap it!**

Leave the core untouched and only modernize how your system talks to the outside world.



**Replace it!**

Build new when the old system is more burden than value.



**Divide It!**

Cut your system along its natural boundaries so one change no longer puts the whole system at risk.



**Extract!**

Pull the knowledge out of your system before you take the next step.



**Preserve it!**

Preserve your system so you can still start it when needed, without actively maintaining it.



**Replatform it!**

Give your system a new foundation when the code is still good but what is underneath no longer is.



**Rehost it!**

Move your system to a new environment and leave everything else as it is.



**Upgrade Tools!**

Bring your tooling up to date so legacy work becomes more efficient.



**Align Strategy!**

Align your organization's strategic direction toward a realistic approach to legacy.



**Reshape Org!**

Reshape teams, responsibilities, and incentives so legacy work finally works well.



**Upskill People!**

Invest in the people you already have before investing in new technology.



**Improve Processes!**

Improve not the system, but the way your team works with it.

Strategy Categories:  Business (14)  Development (10)  Infrastructure (3)  Enablement (5)



Companion Website

